

FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH



BELLTOWER *December 2025*



From the Pastor

We live in a day and age when there is much to be feared. For some, it might be where the next meal is coming from, for others it might be the state of the world, for others it might be spiders and other creepy things. Regardless of what we are afraid of, I think we can acknowledge that there is something that we may fret about. During the Advent and Christmas Season, we will be considering “What do you fear?” We will have an opportunity to face the fears of this world in light of the HOPE that we have in Christ. This season is a season of hope and joy!

While the world around us encourages us to purchase the perfect gifts, have every bow tied just right, the tree trimmed, the turkey golden brown, and the most beautiful table setting, Christ calls us to focus on the hope of the season. Society wants us to be overly busy and stressed out. I want to encourage you to do the opposite. Seek the things that bring you joy and hope. The ones that help you grow spiritually, and to be more like Christ.

Each week worship will be crafted around our theme “What do you fear? Insisting on HOPE this Advent.” There will be a variety of other ways to engage in the theme. On Sunday, after we have a time of fellowship, we will have the opportunity to continue conversation around the theme. It will allow us to go a little bit deeper together, but not be a major time commitment. There will also be opportunities to consider the theme at home through an advent calendar, posts on Facebook, or an advent devotional. I hope you will find these materials helpful in taking a little time to slow down and find HOPE this season.

Rev. Nikelle

From the Christian Education Committee



A six-week Advent Series starts November 30, 2025

These 6, stand-alone lessons, will be presented by Pastor Nikelle and will follow our Fellowship time in the Social Hall.

The series is called: What do you fear? Insisting on HOPE this Advent.



On Sunday, December 14th, breakfast will be served during Fellowship time and will include the Advent lesson. This is for all of us to gather as we prepare for the celebration of Christmas - of the birth of our Christ- the HOPE of the World!

Year End Gifts

With the end of our calendar year nearing, this is the time to think about your “year-end giving”. Please have any offerings to the church office by the middle of December.

The Per Capita apportionment for 2025 at \$44.00 per member (100) totaled \$4,400.00. Our church pays the full amount to Presbytery regardless of what is received from members. As of November end, we have received \$3,600 in member donations toward this benevolence. This is the best the church has ever done in recent years to meet this important obligation. Thank you to those who met their \$44 per member amount and to those who gave over and above!

There are a variety of areas that can use a boost in donations. For example: the Flower Fund, Per Capita Giving, Future Roof Fund etc. Feel free to call the office with any questions about where help is needed.

As a spiritual guide, refer to Matthew 6:19-21 *For where your treasure is, there your heart will be also.*

Gratefully, Finance Committee

Fall Work Day – November 13, 2025



Each Wednesday we join in prayer as a community.

We invite you to join us.

This month's prayer was submitted by Toni Vella.

Dear God,

Sometimes I get too caught up in Christmas commercialism. OK, a lot of times. Today, I'm going to refocus my heart and remember why I'm celebrating this wonderful day in the first place. I'm celebrating Jesus today...and every day!

In Jesus name, Amen. *attributed to Sharon Jaynes*

ANNOUNCEMENTS

Our Prayer Chain is now being handled by Susie Smith and Evelyn Thomas. You can contact Susie if you have a request to share and she will email the Prayer Chain. Evelyn will be Susie's backup. If you submit a request to the Prayer Chain it will be held in confidence with only those members and the pastor, until you share on Sunday morning or yourself. If you would like to be on the Prayer Chain let Susie or Evelyn know and you will be added. Thank you to all those who pray for the requests we receive.

MISSION & WITNESS



DECEMBER 2025 SCHEDULE OF WORSHIP HELPERS

December 7, 2025 2nd Sunday of Advent
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder & Liturgist: Lance Schaefer
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship: Donut Day
Communion Preparer: Sheri Hill & Gayle Topping

December 24, 2025 Christmas Eve Candlelight Service
Musician: Anne Badger
Details to come.

December 14, 2025 3rd Sunday of Advent
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Sarah Bingaman
Ushers:
A/V: Cathy Anderson & Lance Schaefer
Fellowship Host: Christian Education Advent Breakfast

December 28, 2025
Musician: Crystal Kalebaugh-Green
Elder & Liturgist: Tom Cartwright
Ushers:
A/V: Cathy Anderson & Lance Schaefer
Fellowship Host:

December 21, 2025 4th Sunday of Advent
Musician: Carolyn McBride
Elder: Phil Vella & Liturgist: Toni Vella
Ushers:
A/V: Angie & Dan Montague
Fellowship Host:

January 4, 2026
Musician:
Elder & Liturgist:
Ushers:
A/V:
Fellowship Host:
Communion Preparer: Susie Jones & Phil Devers

If you would like to help with our Sunday tasks let Pastor or Lois know which one and they will connect you with that scheduler. Thank you!

December 2025 Birthdays & Anniversaries

Birthdays

12/01 Phil Devers	12/07 Bill Shaw	12/10 Tom Wadsworth
12/13 Wendy Clevenger	12/14 Gordon Nicklaus	12/17 Alyssa Schaefer
12/17 Phil Vella	12/21 Paula Lucas	12/23 Jim Rickert
12/26 Jan Hartman	12/29 Carolyn McBride	12/30 Shirley Katner
12/30 Addison Hoyle	12/31 Robert McBride	

Anniversaries

12/20 Wendell & Linda Ebbens
12/30 Robert & Carolyn McBride
12/30 Tom & Nancy Wadsworth



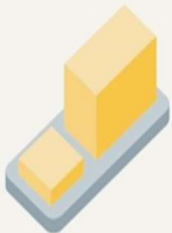
December 1st WORD OF THE DAY Longing BREATH PRAYER INHALE: God listens EXHALE: to my deepest longings.	December 2nd WORDS OF THE DAY Break in BREATH PRAYER INHALE: May your light break in. EXHALE: May your love bring healing.	December 3rd WORD OF THE DAY Fear BREATH PRAYER INHALE: My fears are valid, EXHALE: and God is near.	December 4th WORD OF THE DAY Possibility BREATH PRAYER INHALE: God, help me see EXHALE: all that is possible.	December 5th WORD OF THE DAY Presence BREATH PRAYER INHALE: When I'm afraid, EXHALE: God responds with presence.
December 6th WORD OF THE DAY Marvel BREATH PRAYER INHALE: May I marvel EXHALE: at each tiny miracle.	December 7th WORD OF THE DAY Hope BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Hope that trembles EXHALE: is still hope.	December 8th WORD OF THE DAY Perceive BREATH PRAYER INHALE: God is making all things new. EXHALE: May I perceive it.	December 9th WORD OF THE DAY Trust BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Today I will trust EXHALE: that my efforts matter.	December 10th WORD OF THE DAY Useful BREATH PRAYER INHALE: When I do not feel hopeful, EXHALE: help me become useful.
December 11th WORD OF THE DAY Conviction BREATH PRAYER INHALE: When I feel uncertain, EXHALE: steady my convictions.	December 12th WORD OF THE DAY Transformation BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Help me witness EXHALE: every quiet transformation.	December 13th WORD OF THE DAY Reorient BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Reorient my path EXHALE: to walk humbly with God.	December 14th WORD OF THE DAY Be BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Let it be. EXHALE: Let it be with me.	December 15th WORD OF THE DAY Yes BREATH PRAYER INHALE: A hesitant yes EXHALE: can still be holy.
December 16th WORD OF THE DAY Courage BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Help me step forward, EXHALE: even when I tremble.	December 17th WORD OF THE DAY Magnify BREATH PRAYER INHALE: May I magnify the good EXHALE: that surrounds me.	December 18th WORD OF THE DAY Awaken BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Awaken me EXHALE: to my fullest, radiant self.	December 19th WORD OF THE DAY Vulnerability BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Deep vulnerability EXHALE: can create deep possibility.	December 20th WORD OF THE DAY Love BREATH PRAYER INHALE: May I seek and share EXHALE: the love that flows from God.
December 21st WORD OF THE DAY Dream BREATH PRAYER INHALE: God's dreams unfold EXHALE: through the work of our hands.	December 22nd WORD OF THE DAY Companionship BREATH PRAYER INHALE: May I find companionship EXHALE: when I need a hand to hold.	December 23rd WORD OF THE DAY Promise BREATH PRAYER INHALE: In this fragile, imperfect world, EXHALE: may your promises take root.	December 24th WORD OF THE DAY Joy BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Today I will make space EXHALE: for joy that grows and grows.	December 25th WORDS OF THE DAY Good news BREATH PRAYER INHALE: Good news is greater than fear. EXHALE: God will not be silenced.

Advent Calendar
Daily breath prayers



ADVENT CALENDAR

We are beginning our Advent celebration early! Bring items from the list each week to help stock the mini food pantry at the Dixon Public Library. Place items in provided blue bags. Our contributions will gradually be added to the pantry as needed..

	The week ending November 16 Canned soup with pop top		The week ending November 23 Canned vegetables with pop top	
 shutterstock.com - 154942877	The week ending November 30 8 oz or less bottle of dish soap		The week ending December 7 5 pound or less bag of sugar	
	The week ending December 14 Pound of butter or small bottle of cooking oil		The week ending December 21 Spices or cake mix	
	The week ending December 28 Canned tuna or noodles		Thank you for your generosity!	

December 2025

Sunday	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday	Saturday
	1 6:00pm NO Quilters Meeting	2 9:30am NO Innermission Committee 1:30pm Worship Committee Meeting 3:00pm Mission/Witness Committee 4:00pm Finance & Property Committee	3 5:00pm Christian Education Committee	4 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	5	6
7 8:00am Choir Rehearsal 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	8 11:30am PEO Chapter AC Meeting	9	10	11	12	13
14 8:00am Choir Rehearsal 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Advent Celebration Brunch	15 1:00pm PW Bible Study	16 6:30pm NO Session Meeting	17 Newsletter Deadline	18 4:00pm Caregiver Support Meeting	19	20
21 Special Congregation Meeting after service 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	22	23	24 5:00pm Christmas Eve Candlelight Service	25 Christmas Day - Office closed	26 Office closed	27
28 9:30am Worship Service 10:30am Fellowship Hour	29	30	31			



**First Presbyterian Church of Dixon
Sunday Service: 9:30 a.m.**

Find us on Facebook & YouTube.

www.fpcdixon.com

Pastor: Rev. Nikelle Johnson
Administrative Assistant: Lois Grimm
Custodian: Julie Glenn

Music Director: Kathleen Schaefer
A/V Tech: Carolyn McBride

OUR PURPOSE STATEMENT

As followers of Jesus Christ, we will, by our intentional actions,
seek a deeper relationship with God,
listen for the Spirit's call to mission in our community,
and prayerfully lead others to know the joy of God's love,
and to realize God's purpose for life's journey.

